

Yoga for beginners

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General Instructions for Practice of Yoga Asanas

1. Do not perform asanas immediately after meals. Leave about 4 hours after a heavy meal and at least two hours after a light one. Avoid stimulating drinks.
2. Yoga Asanas can be performed before or after bath, but allow about half-an-hour between asanas and bath.
3. Asanas, and physical exercises should not be combined. After stretching and similar exercises, perform Savasana for a sufficient length of time before starting asanas.
4. Relaxing the body in a posture is of vital importance. Remove all tensions in the final posture. Relax for a few minutes in between the °sanas.
5. After the Yoga Asanas, one should feel fresh and relaxed; never tired, exhausted or sweating.
6. Do not overexert beyond your capacity to maintain the postures for long durations. Instead, adjust the timings according to your progress
7. Daily practice is essential for fast progress.
8. Women should not practise asanas during the menstrual period. One should stop practising asanas after the fifth month of pregnancy up to two or three months after the confinement except under expert guidance.
9. If you have any medical conditions or injuries in the past please consult your doctor before you practice asanas and pranayama

Starting Prayer(Shanti Mantra):

ôm sahamāvavatu sahanaubhunaktu saha viryam karavāvahai
tejasvināvadhitamastu mām vidvisāvahai
ôm Śāntih Śāntih Śāntih

-- Kathópanisadd Śāntimantra

Meaning in English:

May He protect us both. May He nourish us both. May we both work together with great energy. May our study be enlightening and fruitful. May we never hate each other. Om Peace Peace Peace.'

This prayer is for inculcating the right attitude for learning. It focuses on how education is a team effort; what should be the attitude towards each other and what are the objectives and fruits of learning.

Suryanamaskar Mantra

Hiranmayena Pātreṇa Satyasyāpihitam Mukham,
Tattvam Pusan Apāvṛnu Satya-dharmāya Drstave

-- Iṣāvāsyôpanisad, Śloka 15

Meaning in English:

Like a lid to a vessel, O Sun, your Golden orb covers the entrance to Truth. Kindly open the entrance, to lead me to Truth.

Mantras to chant before each Surya Namaskara:

Each round of Sūryanamaskāra is done after the utterance of “Omkar” with the appropriate “Bija” Mantra, along with the corresponding name of Sun God

Aum **Hrām Mitrāya** Namah

Aum **Hrim Ravaye** Namah

Aum **Hrūm Suryaya** Namah

Aum **Hraim Bhānave** Namah

Aum **Hroum Khagaya** Namah

Aum **Hrah Pūsne** Namah

Aum **Hram Hiranyagarbhāya** Namah

Aum **Hrim Maricaye** Namah

Aum **Hrūm Ādityaya** Namah

Aum **Hraim Savitre** Namah

Aum **Hroum Arkaya** Namah

Aum **Hrah Bhāskaraya** Namah

A gist of benefits of chanting the above mantras:

The Pranava Om stimulates all the vital internal organs of the body, specially the brain, heart and stomach.

Hrām acts as a stimulus to the brain, heart, alimentary canal, respiratory organs, such as nose, windpipe, throat, lungs and chest and upper ribs.

Hrim invigorates the throat, palate, heart, respiratory and digestive organs.

Hrūm strengthens the liver, spleen, stomach, abdomen, hypogastrium, uterus and intestines.

Hraim stimulates kidneys.

Hroum normalizes the function of the rectum and anus.

Hrah develops the chest and throat.

Almost all the diseases are found to originate either in the head, nose, throat, heart, lungs or abdomen. When all these parts are purged of their impurities or toxins by Pranava and Bijas, the circulation of blood receives stimulation by the vigorous movements of the limbs and organs in the process of Namaskars.

Thus all these seemingly meaningless Pranava and Bijas produce simulations and vibrations in different vital parts of the system.

Source/Reference:

Book on Surya Namaskar published in 1940 by Shri Bala Pant Pratinidhi

Surya Namaskar - An Instruction Booklet by Vivekananda Kendra Kanyakumari

Pranayama Mantra

pranasyedam vaṣe sarvaṃ tridive yatpratisthitam
mateva putrān rakṣasva Śriṣca prajñām ca videhi na iti

-- praśnópanisad 2.13

Meaning in English:

Whatever exists in the three worlds, is all under the control of Prana. O Prana! Protect us, as a mother protects her children and bestow us affluence and understanding.

Ending Prayer(Shanti Mantra):

sarvē bhavantu sukhinaḥ sarvē santu nirāmayāḥ
sarvē bhadraṇi paśyantu mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavēt
ôṃ Śāntih Śāntih Śāntih

Meaning in English:

Let all be happy. Let all be free from diseases. Let all see what is auspicious for life. Let none be subject to misery.

Yamas and Niyamas from Astanga Yoga:

Yamas:

Observances and restraints that regulate our interaction with others.

1. Satya - Truthfulness in every aspect of our daily life
2. Ahimsa - Love all is the practice of ahimsa .Don't harm others even in thought or word.
3. Bramhacharya - Self restraint.Do not indulge too much in anything
4. Aparigraha - Reducing desires and wants and leading a simple life away from all the luxuries
5. Asteya - Do not covet for the wealth of others

Niyamas:

Observances and restraints which govern an individual's personal life.

1. Saucha - Internal and external purity .Get rid of any evil vrittis or habits
2. Santosha - Contentment with what we have
3. Tapas - Austerity ,Egolessness and selfless service,control of will are forms of Tapas.
4. Svadhyaya - Self study of religious scriptures ,chanting of prayers and mantras
5. Isvara Pranidhana - Complete surrender to the higher power,god or super consciousness

Spiritual Diary Sample Format:

	Mon	Tues	Wed	Thus	Fri	Sat	Sun	Total
Date:								
Wake Up time								
Time to Bed								
Sleep Hours								
Asana Time								
Pranayama time								
Meditation Time								
One Yama/Niyama								

How we may do the recording:

- Have a notebook in a convenient place to remind you
- Best is to complete the diary before going to bed or first thing the next day
- You can use a Excel Sheet or any other journal software as well
- You can give a tick or cross mark if you have followed the yama or niyama or failed and even how many times you have succeeded or failed.

30 Min Daily Practice:

	Number	Time Taken in minutes
Sithilikarana Vyayama		
Jogging(back,front ,side)		1 min
Mukha Douthi	5	1/2
Situps	5	1/2
Side and Forward bending	5	1/2
Shoulder Rotation	5	1/2
Neck Rotation(both sides)	3	1

		4
Surya Namaskara	6	6
Asanas		
Standing:		
1.Ardhakati Chakrasana		2
2.Pada Hastasana		1
3.Ardha Chakrasana		1/2
Sitting:		
1.Ustrasana or Suptha Vajrasana		1
2.Vakrasana(both sides)		2
3.Sasankasana		1
Lying:		
1.Bhujangasana		1
2.Sarvangasana		2

3.Matsyasana		1
4.Savasana		3
Pranayama:		
1.Kapalabhati	60 strokes	1
2.Anuloma Viloma	9 rounds	2
3.Meditation		2
Prayer (Starting and Ending)		2

60 Min Daily Practice:

	Number	Time Taken in minutes
Sithilikarana Vyayama		
Jogging(back,front ,side)		1 min
Mukha Douthi	10	$\frac{1}{2}$
Situps	10	1/2
Side and Forward bending	10	1/2

Shoulder Rotation	10	$\frac{1}{2}$
Neck Rotation(both sides)	5	1
		4
Surya Namaskara	12	12
Quick Relaxation		2
Asanas		
Standing:		
1.Ardhakati Chakrasana		2
2.Pada Hastasana		1
3.Ardha Chakrasana		$\frac{1}{2}$
Sitting:		
1.Ustrasana		1
2.Vakrasana(both sides)		2
3.Sasankasana		1
4.Suptha Vajrasana		1

Prone:		
1.Bhujangasana		1
2.Salabasana		1
3.Dhanurasana		1
Supine:		
1.Sarvangasana		1
2.Matsyasana		1
3.Sethu Banda Asana		1
4.Savasana		3
Instant Relaxation		2
Pranayama:		
1.Kapalabhati	120 strokes	2
2.Nadi Suddhi	9 rounds	2
3.Meditation		10
Prayer (Starting and Ending)		2

